

A

Rise and fall

These verbs describe **trends** [movements] in **sales** [how much you sell], prices, etc.

When sales or prices **rise / go up / increase**, they can do it in different ways:

They can rise **slightly** [a bit]. →

They can rise **gradually** [slowly over a long period]. ↗

They can rise **sharply** [quickly and by a large amount]. ↗

The opposite can also happen. Prices or sales can **fall / go down / decrease** slightly, gradually or sharply. If prices don't rise or fall, they **stay the same**. →

We use certain prepositions to say by how much something rises or falls.

The price has risen **by** 10 pence. Sales fell **from** 8,000 units **to** 6,500 units.

Rise/increase and **fall/decrease** can also be used as nouns, with certain prepositions.

There's been a **gradual rise in** prices. We've seen a **slight increase in** profit.

There's been a **sharp fall in** sales. Profits were £5 million, which is a **decrease of** 10%.

Language help

Profit is the money you receive from your business after you have paid all your costs (*opp* **loss**).

*Last year the company **made a profit of** €2 million but this year they could **make a loss**.*

B

Financial language

With the **economy**¹ now improving, banks are reporting **positive signs**² that the number of **loans**³ is increasing.

With **inflation**⁴ expected to rise, there are **growing fears**⁵ that **interest rates**⁶ could go up by as much as **2%**⁷ next year.

EUROPE



Figures⁸ published yesterday show that **trade**⁹ between the two countries has now risen for the fifth year **in a row**¹⁰.

CURRENCY

Although the **value**¹¹ of the pound fell slightly against the dollar yesterday, the news that sales rose in the last **quarter**¹² has **raised**¹³ hopes that we may be coming out of **recession**¹⁴.

→ [Read full story](#)

¹ the system by which a country's trade, industry and money are organised

² something which shows something is happening

³ money that you borrow

⁴ the rate at which prices increase

⁵ increasing worries

⁶ (see language help below)

⁷ this is spoken as *two per cent*

⁸ an amount shown in numbers, e.g. 500

⁹ buying and selling between countries

¹⁰ one after another with no break

¹¹ the money that something can be sold for

¹² (in business) a period of three months

¹³ increased; you can also **raise prices**

¹⁴ a time when the economy is not successful

Language help

Interest is what the bank **charges** you [asks you to pay] when you borrow money from them, and the **interest rate** is how much you must pay as a **percentage**, e.g. **5%**, **8%**, etc. So, if you borrow £100 for a year and the interest rate is 15% a year, you'll have to **pay back** £115.